

With those details in mind, it is more important than ever to save for retirement—and to start saving early. Here are just a few facts about Americans and retirement:

- 25% of Americans have no money saved for retirement.⁴⁶
- 64% of Americans have \$10,000 or less saved for retirement.⁴⁷
- 44% of Americans are still paying off their home when they retire.⁴⁸
- 56% of Americans lose sleep when they think about retirement.⁴⁹

As you can see, the retirement situation for many Americans is bleak at best. But now that I have bummed you out with those statistics, I am going to give you the knowledge and advice to help you avoid being in one of these dire situations. This chapter is going to explain the most common investment options people use to save for retirement and how to use them to your advantage. When you are finished reading, you will understand the different ways that Americans save for retirement, and you can begin preparing early to achieve your retirement goals.

46 Niall McCarthy, "Report. A Quarter of Americans Have No Retirement Savings [Infographic]," *Forbes*, June 3, 2019, <https://www.forbes.com/sites/niallmccarthy/2019/06/03/report-a-quarter-of-americans-have-no-retirement-savings-infographic>.

47 Sean Dennison, "64% of Americans Aren't Prepared for Retirement—and 48% Don't Care," *GOBankingRates*, September 23, 2019, <https://www.gobankingrates.com/retirement/planning/why-americans-will-retire-broke>.

48 Kim Hayes, "Many Retired People Don't Expect to Pay Off Mortgages," *American Association of Retired Persons (AARP)*, March 26, 2018, <https://www.aarp.org/money/credit-loans-debt/info-2018/retired-paying-off-mortgage-fd.html>.

49 "Stress and Anxiety Surrounding Retirement," *DaveRamsey.com*, August 10, 2016, <https://www.daveramsey.com/research/stress-anxiety>.